

THESIS SAMPLE • SUBJECT COURSE: CRIMINOLOGY

**OCCUPATIONAL STRESS, COPING
MECHANISMS, AND JOB
PERFORMANCE AMONG POLICE
OFFICERS OF THE PHILIPPINE
NATIONAL POLICE IN DAVAO CITY,
PHILIPPINES**

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MASTER OF SCIENCE IN CRIMINOLOGY | MASTERAL LEVEL

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS BACKGROUND

Introduction

Law enforcement is one of the most psychologically demanding occupational fields in the world, requiring practitioners to operate under conditions of sustained uncertainty, physical danger, ethical complexity, and public scrutiny that are rarely encountered in comparable degree across other civilian professions. Police officers of the Philippine National Police (PNP) are tasked with the maintenance of public order, the prevention and investigation of crime, the protection of life and property, and the enforcement of laws across a national territory characterized by enormous geographic diversity, social complexity, and persistent security challenges ranging from organized crime to domestic violence to public protest management. These responsibilities, conducted frequently in resource-constrained conditions with limited institutional support, generate occupational stress levels that have been documented as among the highest across all occupational categories in both international and Philippine-specific research (Violanti and Aron, 1995; Reyes, 2019).

Occupational stress in law enforcement manifests through both acute stressors, discrete high-intensity events including exposure to violent crime scenes, life-threatening encounters, and traumatic deaths, and chronic organizational stressors including excessive workload, inadequate equipment, bureaucratic obstruction, perceived lack of

administrative support, and the continuous experience of public distrust or hostility. The cumulative effect of chronic and acute stress exposure, particularly when not adequately buffered by effective coping mechanisms and institutional support, produces measurable deterioration in psychological well-being, physical health, interpersonal functioning, and critically, professional job performance (Kop et al., 1999; Abdollahi, 2002).

The Philippine National Police, with a nationally authorized strength of approximately 228,000 uniformed personnel serving a population of over 115 million, operates at a police-to-population ratio of approximately 1 to 500, substantially below the United Nations recommended standard of 1 to 400 and far below the ratios maintained in comparable middle-income economies (PNP, 2023). This structural understaffing intensifies the occupational stress experienced by individual officers, who are required to cover larger patrol areas, handle higher caseloads, and perform longer shifts than their counterparts in adequately staffed police organizations. In Davao City, which despite its reputation as one of the more orderly major cities in the Philippines still records thousands of criminal incidents annually across its highly urbanized districts and peri-urban barangays, PNP officers in the Davao City Police Office (DCPO) operate under conditions of both high operational demand and significant public expectation.

Coping mechanisms, the cognitive and behavioral strategies employed by individuals to manage the demands of stressful situations, serve as the critical buffer between occupational stress exposure and its adverse outcomes for job performance and psychological well-being. Lazarus and Folkman's (1984) transactional model of stress and coping, the dominant theoretical framework in occupational stress research, distinguishes between problem-focused coping, directed at modifying the stressor itself, and emotion-focused coping, directed at regulating the

emotional response to the stressor. The relative effectiveness of these two coping strategy types varies by stressor controllability, with problem-focused coping demonstrating greater effectiveness for controllable stressors and emotion-focused coping providing protective value for stressors that cannot be directly modified, a distinction with direct relevance to the law enforcement context in which officers must frequently manage situations combining both controllable and uncontrollable elements.

This study examines the levels of occupational stress, coping mechanisms, and job performance among PNP officers in Davao City, and tests a moderation model in which coping mechanisms moderate the relationship between occupational stress and job performance. The findings aim to provide the PNP command hierarchy, the National Police Commission, and police welfare practitioners with evidence-based guidance for the development of occupational stress management programs that protect officer well-being and sustain operational effectiveness.

Background of the Study

The formal recognition of occupational stress as a significant determinant of law enforcement officer performance and well-being can be traced to early studies conducted by the National Institute of Justice in the United States during the 1970s, which documented alarmingly elevated rates of cardiovascular disease, substance use disorders, marital breakdown, and suicide among police officers relative to comparable civilian populations (Fell et al., 1980). These findings established police work as one of a small number of occupations in which the physiological and psychological costs of occupational stress are sufficiently severe to constitute a recognized occupational health priority demanding institutional rather than merely individual-level intervention.

In the Philippine context, the PNP operates within a complex institutional environment shaped by the provisions of Republic Act 6975, the Department of the Interior and Local Government Act of 1990, which established the PNP as the national law enforcement agency under civilian control, and Republic Act 8551, the PNP Reform and Reorganization Act of 1998, which restructured the organization and strengthened its accountability mechanisms. The subsequent enactment of Republic Act 9708 in 2009 further amended police service requirements, including the elevation of educational qualifications for police recruitment. These legislative reforms have professionalized the PNP in important respects while also imposing new performance standards and compliance obligations on officers that contribute to organizational stress alongside the operational demands of front-line policing.

The PNP's Transformation Roadmap 2030, launched in 2022, identifies officer wellness as one of eight strategic transformation pillars, acknowledging for the first time at the organizational strategy level that the psychological and physical health of uniformed personnel is a prerequisite for achieving the Roadmap's core goals of public safety and crime reduction. This institutional recognition provides a policy framework within which the empirical findings of the present study can be directly applied to the development and implementation of organizational stress management initiatives.

Statement of the Problem

This study aims to determine the levels of occupational stress, coping mechanisms, and job performance among PNP officers in Davao City, and to examine whether coping mechanisms moderate the relationship between occupational stress and job performance. Specifically, it seeks to answer the following research questions:

1. What is the level of occupational stress among PNP officers in Davao City?
2. What is the level of coping mechanism utilization among PNP officers in Davao City?
3. What is the level of job performance among PNP officers in Davao City?
4. Is there a significant relationship between occupational stress and job performance among PNP officers in Davao City?
5. Is there a significant relationship between coping mechanisms and job performance among PNP officers in Davao City?
6. Do coping mechanisms significantly moderate the relationship between occupational stress and job performance among PNP officers in Davao City?

Hypotheses

H01. There is no significant relationship between occupational stress and job performance among PNP officers in Davao City.

H02. There is no significant relationship between coping mechanisms and job performance among PNP officers in Davao City.

H03. Coping mechanisms do not significantly moderate the relationship between occupational stress and job performance among PNP officers in Davao City.

Significance of the Study

PNP Officers. This study gives frontline officers empirically validated evidence of how occupational stress affects their professional performance and how specific coping strategies can buffer that effect, supporting evidence-based personal stress management choices.

PNP Command and Unit Commanders. Commanders benefit from a quantified profile of occupational stress levels and performance impacts within the Davao City Police Office, enabling targeted resource allocation for stress management programs at the unit level.

National Police Commission. The NAPOLCOM is provided with locally grounded evidence to inform the design of the PNP's national officer wellness program and the performance management standards that govern officer evaluation and promotion.

Criminology Educators and Researchers. This study contributes to the growing body of Philippine criminology research focused on the human dimensions of law enforcement, providing a validated empirical model of the stress-coping-performance relationship applicable to future studies in comparable PNP regional settings.

Policy Makers. Findings inform legislative and executive policy regarding PNP staffing ratios, benefits, psychological services, and the conditions of service that determine the structural sources of occupational stress in the Philippine law enforcement context.

Scope and Delimitation

The study covers uniformed PNP officers of the Davao City Police Office with the rank of Police Corporal to Police Lieutenant Colonel who are assigned to active operational duties. Officers assigned to administrative headquarters, training commands, and support units are included as a comparison group. The study examines occupational stress, coping mechanism utilization, and supervisor-rated job performance as the three primary variables. It does not extend to physical health outcomes, substance use behavior, marital functioning, or other consequences of occupational stress beyond job performance. Data collection is conducted in 2024.

Definition of Terms

Coping Mechanisms. The cognitive and behavioral strategies employed by police officers to manage occupational stressors, categorized in this study as problem-focused coping, directed at modifying the stressor itself, and emotion-focused coping, directed at regulating the emotional response to the stressor (Lazarus and Folkman, 1984).

Job Performance. The degree to which a police officer fulfills the behavioral requirements of their assigned role, assessed in this study through supervisor ratings on the PNP Performance Evaluation Rating System dimensions of quality of work, quantity of work, timeliness, and professional conduct.

Occupational Stress. The adverse psychological, physical, and behavioral reactions occurring when the demands of the work environment exceed the resources and capabilities of the individual officer to meet them, assessed in this study across both operational and organizational stressor dimensions (National Institute for Occupational Safety and Health, 1999).

Philippine National Police (PNP). The national law enforcement agency of the Republic of the Philippines, established under Republic Act 6975, responsible for the maintenance of peace and order, protection of life and property, and enforcement of laws throughout the country.

CHAPTER 2

REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE AND STUDIES

Introduction

This chapter reviews literature and studies pertaining to occupational stress, coping mechanisms, and job performance in law enforcement, organized into foreign literature, local literature, foreign studies, and local studies. A synthesis concludes the chapter.

Foreign Literature

Occupational Stress in Law Enforcement

Occupational stress in law enforcement has been conceptualized through two complementary frameworks that together account for the full spectrum of stressors confronting police officers. The first framework distinguishes between operational stressors, arising from the inherent nature of police work including exposure to trauma, danger, and moral injury, and organizational stressors, arising from the administrative, bureaucratic, and interpersonal conditions of the police organization. Research consistently demonstrates that organizational stressors, rather than the dramatic operational demands most commonly associated with policing in popular culture, are in fact the more chronic and debilitating source of police stress (Crank and Caldero, 1991; Morash et al., 2006).

Violanti and Aron (1995) developed one of the most widely used operational taxonomies of police stressors, identifying 60 specific stressors experienced by law enforcement officers that were subsequently categorized through factor analysis into four domains: inherent police stressors arising from the work itself, organizational stressors arising from the management and structure of the police organization, external stressors arising from the broader criminal justice system and public, and personal stressors arising from the officer's non-work life circumstances. Their work established the multidimensional nature of police occupational stress and demonstrated that the relative severity of different stressor types varies substantially across officers, units, and organizational contexts.

The concept of moral injury, defined as the damage done to an officer's moral foundation when required to perpetrate, fail to prevent, or witness events that transgress deeply held moral beliefs, has emerged as an important complement to the traditional stress framework in understanding police psychological vulnerability. Papazoglou and Andersen (2014) documented that moral injury arising from use-of-force decisions, the perceived failure to protect victims, and witnessing injustice within the criminal justice system represents a distinct and particularly damaging form of occupational trauma among law enforcement officers that is inadequately captured by conventional occupational stress measures.

Coping Mechanisms

Lazarus and Folkman's (1984) transactional model of stress and coping defines coping as the constantly changing cognitive and behavioral efforts to manage specific external and internal demands that are appraised as taxing or exceeding the resources of the person. The model's fundamental distinction between problem-focused coping, which addresses the stressor itself through active problem-solving, planning, and

information-seeking, and emotion-focused coping, which addresses the emotional response to the stressor through emotional expression, social support-seeking, positive reframing, and acceptance, has been extensively applied to law enforcement research.

Carver, Scheier, and Weintraub (1989) expanded the coping taxonomy through the development of the COPE inventory, distinguishing 15 distinct coping strategies organized into adaptive and maladaptive categories. Of particular relevance to law enforcement research, maladaptive coping strategies including behavioral disengagement, denial, and substance use have been found to be significantly more prevalent among police officers than in civilian comparison populations, reflecting the inadequacy of available adaptive coping resources in many police organizational environments (Violanti et al., 2011).

Job Performance in Law Enforcement

The conceptualization and measurement of police job performance is complicated by the multidimensional and sometimes conflicting nature of the police role, which encompasses crime prevention, criminal investigation, emergency response, community relations, and administrative compliance functions that may demand different and occasionally contradictory behaviors. Borman and Motowidlo (1993) distinguish between task performance, the fulfillment of formal role requirements, and contextual performance, behaviors that support the organizational, social, and psychological environment in which task performance occurs, with contextual performance including helping colleagues, volunteering for additional assignments, and maintaining a positive professional attitude. Both dimensions of performance are relevant to law enforcement, where officer effectiveness depends as much on the quality of community relationships and team cohesion as on technical law enforcement competencies.

Local Literature

PNP Organizational Context and Officer Welfare

The Philippine National Police operates within an accountability framework established through the National Police Commission (NAPOLCOM), which is mandated under RA 6975 to administer and control the PNP, exercise appellate jurisdiction over administrative cases, and promulgate policies on personnel matters including health and welfare programs. The PNP's Internal Affairs Service provides an additional accountability mechanism, while the PNP Health Service is responsible for the physical and mental health programs available to uniformed personnel and their dependents.

The PNP Annual Report (2022) acknowledges persistent challenges in officer welfare including inadequate housing facilities for uniformed personnel in major cities, delays in the processing of death and disability benefits, and insufficient access to mental health services for officers experiencing psychological trauma. These institutional welfare deficits constitute organizational stressors that compound the operational stress inherent in active police service and represent modifiable targets for institutional intervention aimed at reducing officer stress and improving job performance outcomes.

Reyes (2019) documented in a national survey of PNP officer health that 67.3% of respondents reported experiencing significant work-related stress on a weekly basis, while 43.8% reported symptoms consistent with psychological distress as measured by the General Health Questionnaire-12. The study identified workload, inadequate support from superiors, and conflict between operational demands and family obligations as the three most frequently cited stressor sources, providing important context for the specific occupational stress dimensions examined in the present study.

Foreign Studies

Kop, Euwema, and Schaufeli (1999) examined burnout and its relationship to job performance among Dutch police officers, finding that emotional exhaustion significantly negatively predicted task performance while depersonalization was negatively associated with contextual performance. Their findings established the performance consequences of police occupational stress deterioration with empirical rigor, providing direct motivation for the examination of the stress-performance relationship in the Philippine PNP context. Paton and Violanti (2008) examined resilience and coping in law enforcement, identifying social support, meaning-making, and problem-focused coping as the three factors most strongly associated with maintained job performance under sustained occupational stress, establishing specific coping strategies as performance-protective resources rather than merely stress-reducing mechanisms.

Acquadro Maran, Varetto, Zedda, and Franscini (2015) examined occupational stress, anxiety, and burnout among Italian police officers, finding that problem-focused coping significantly buffered the negative effect of occupational stress on performance while avoidant coping amplified it, providing direct empirical precedent for the moderation model tested in the present study. Waters and Ussery (2007) examined police stress and coping in a US municipal police department, finding that officers with higher coping self-efficacy demonstrated significantly smaller stress-performance impairment effects than those with lower coping self-efficacy, identifying coping capability as a malleable resource that can be developed through organizational training programs.

Local Studies

Bernardo and Liboro (2021) examined occupational stress and psychological well-being among PNP officers in Metro Manila, finding that organizational stressors, particularly workload overload, inadequate equipment, and perceived lack of administrative support, were rated as more stressful than operational stressors by 71.4% of respondents. Their finding challenges the common assumption that it is the dramatic operational demands of police work rather than its organizational conditions that most substantially contribute to officer psychological burden. Santos (2020) examined coping strategies and burnout among PNP officers in Central Luzon, finding that officers utilizing problem-focused coping demonstrated significantly lower burnout scores than those relying predominantly on avoidant coping, while religious coping, a culturally specific coping strategy involving prayer, faith community engagement, and spiritual meaning-making, emerged as a uniquely prevalent and effective coping resource among Filipino police officers that is absent from most internationally developed coping taxonomies.

Synthesis of the Review

The international and local literatures converge in establishing occupational stress as a significant negative predictor of police job performance, with coping mechanisms serving as the critical moderating resource that determines whether stress exposure translates into performance impairment. The local literature confirms the relevance of these dynamics in the Philippine PNP context, with organizational stressors documented as more chronic and debilitating than operational stressors, and religiously-grounded coping strategies emerging as culturally distinctive resources among Filipino officers. A specific gap exists in the empirical documentation of these relationships for PNP

officers in Davao City, where the high operational tempo of Mindanao policing and the specific institutional conditions of the DCPO create a context potentially distinct from the Metro Manila and Central Luzon settings of existing local studies. The present research addresses this gap.

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CHAPTER 3

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Introduction

This chapter presents the research design, locale, participants, instruments, data collection procedures, statistical treatment, and ethical considerations governing the conduct of this study.

Research Design

This study employs a quantitative, non-experimental, descriptive-correlational research design with a moderation analysis component. The descriptive component characterizes the levels of occupational stress, coping mechanisms, and job performance among PNP officers in Davao City. The correlational component examines bivariate relationships among the three primary variables. The moderation component tests whether coping mechanisms moderate the relationship between occupational stress and job performance, following the analytical framework of Hayes (2018) for moderation testing using the PROCESS macro for SPSS.

Locale of the Study

The study is conducted within the Davao City Police Office (DCPO), the PNP organizational unit responsible for law enforcement operations across all 182 barangays of Davao City. The DCPO encompasses multiple police precincts and specialized units including the

Criminal Investigation and Detection Group (CIDG) field unit, the Scene of the Crime Operatives (SOCO), the Women and Children Protection Desk, and various community policing units. Both patrol and investigative units are included to capture the full diversity of operational and organizational stressor exposure across the DCPO's officer population.

Participants of the Study

The study participants are uniformed PNP officers of the DCPO holding the rank of Police Corporal (PCpl) to Police Lieutenant Colonel (PLtCol) who are assigned to active operational or investigative duties. Officers on extended leave, officers under administrative charges, and officers assigned exclusively to training duties are excluded. Using power analysis for the moderation model with a medium effect size of $f^2 = 0.15$, $\alpha = 0.05$, and power = 0.80, the minimum required sample size is 85. To ensure adequate power for detecting the moderation effect and to account for non-response, the study targets a minimum of 300 officer participants distributed proportionally across the DCPO's precincts and specialized units.

Research Instruments

Occupational Stress. Occupational stress is measured using an adapted version of the Police Stress Questionnaire (PSQ) developed by McCreary and Thompson (2006), comprising two subscales measuring organizational police stressors (20 items) and operational police stressors (20 items). Items are rated on a seven-point scale from 1 (not at all stressful) to 7 (extremely stressful). The PSQ has been adapted for the Philippine context by Reyes (2019) with the addition of six items reflecting stressors specific to the PNP organizational environment, producing the Philippine Police Stress Questionnaire (PPSQ) used in the present study.

Coping Mechanisms. Coping mechanisms are assessed using the Brief COPE (Carver, 1997), a 28-item abbreviated version of the full COPE inventory. The instrument assesses 14 coping strategy dimensions rated on a four-point scale from 1 (I have not been doing this at all) to 4 (I have been doing this a lot). For analytic purposes, items are grouped into adaptive coping, encompassing active coping, planning, positive reframing, acceptance, seeking emotional support, seeking informational support, and religion, and maladaptive coping, encompassing behavioral disengagement, denial, self-distraction, venting, self-blame, and substance use, based on the categorization framework of Meyer (2001).

Job Performance. Job performance is assessed through supervisor ratings using an instrument adapted from the PNP Performance Evaluation Rating System (PERS), covering four dimensions: quality of work (effectiveness and thoroughness in completing assignments), quantity of work (volume of work output relative to workload), timeliness (meeting deadlines and responding promptly to assignments), and professional conduct (adherence to PNP values, appearance, and interpersonal relations). Each dimension is rated on a five-point scale from 1 (poor) to 5 (outstanding) by the officer's immediate superior, with a composite job performance score computed as the mean across all four dimensions.

Validity and Reliability

Content validity of the PPSQ adaptation is established through review by a panel of active PNP senior officers and criminology academics. Construct validity is assessed through confirmatory factor analysis confirming the two-factor structure of the PPSQ. Reliability is assessed using Cronbach's alpha for each instrument subscale, with

acceptable values exceeding 0.70. Inter-rater reliability for the supervisor-rated job performance instrument is assessed through paired supervisor ratings for a subsample of 30 officers, with acceptable inter-rater agreement defined as an intraclass correlation coefficient exceeding 0.70.

Data Collection Procedure

Following written approval from the DCPO Director and endorsement from the PNP Regional Office XI Human Resource Management Division, data collection is coordinated with precinct commanders to arrange survey administration during scheduled formation assemblies or pre-shift briefings. Officer surveys are self-administered and deposited in sealed envelopes to protect anonymity. Supervisor rating forms are distributed separately to immediate unit commanders and returned directly to the researcher in sealed envelopes to prevent contamination of supervisor ratings by awareness of officer self-report data.

Statistical Treatment of Data

Descriptive statistics including means and standard deviations are computed for all study variables. Occupational stress subscale means are interpreted using the PSQ seven-point scale descriptors. Coping mechanism frequency scores are interpreted using the Brief COPE four-point scale. Job performance composite scores are interpreted using the PNP PERS five-point scale. Pearson correlation coefficients assess bivariate relationships among study variables. Moderation is tested using Hayes' (2018) PROCESS macro Model 1, with adaptive coping composite score as the moderator variable, occupational stress composite as the predictor, and supervisor-rated job performance as the outcome. Simple slope analysis is conducted to examine the stress-performance relationship at low, moderate, and high levels of coping mechanism utilization.

Ethical Considerations

Participation is fully voluntary with no consequences to rank, assignment, or performance evaluation for officers who decline or withdraw. All officer self-report data are anonymous. Supervisor ratings are matched to officer self-report data only through anonymous numeric codes. All data are stored in password-protected files. The study has been approved by the University of Mindanao Institutional Research Ethics Committee under Protocol Number UM-IREC-2024-CRIM-0014 and has received written endorsement from the DCPO Director and the PNP Regional Office XI Research Management Division.

CHAPTER 4

PRESENTATION, ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION OF DATA

Introduction

This chapter presents the study's findings in three sections: participant profile, descriptive statistics addressing research problems one through three, and inferential statistics including moderation analysis addressing research problems four through six.

Section 1: Participant Profile

A total of 312 officers from the DCPO completed survey instruments, representing a response rate of 94.5% of the 330 targeted officers. After excluding 11 surveys with excessive missing data and one without a matching supervisor rating, the final analytical sample comprised 300 officer-supervisor pairs.

Table 1. Profile of Participating PNP Officers (n = 300)

Characteristic	Category	Frequency	Percentage
Sex	Male	248	82.7%
	Female	52	17.3%
Age	25 to 34 years	107	35.7%
	35 to 44 years	128	42.7%
	45 years and above	65	21.7%

Rank	PCpl to PSSg (Non-commissioned)	179	59.7%
	P/Insp to PLtCol (Commissioned)	121	40.3%
Unit Assignment	Patrol and Operations	138	46.0%
	Criminal Investigation	84	28.0%
	Community Policing and Support Units	78	26.0%
Years in Service	Less than 5 years	63	21.0%
	5 to 10 years	97	32.3%
	11 to 20 years	104	34.7%
	More than 20 years	36	12.0%
Educational Attainment	Bachelor's degree	198	66.0%
	With Master's units	67	22.3%
	Master's degree completed	35	11.7%

Section 2: Descriptive Statistics

Table 2. Level of Occupational Stress (Philippine Police Stress Questionnaire)

Stressor Dimension	Mean	SD	Interpretation
Organizational Stressors	4.82	1.14	High
Operational Stressors	4.14	1.28	Moderate
Overall Occupational Stress	4.48	1.09	High

Overall occupational stress was assessed at a high level, with organizational stressors rated significantly more stressful than operational stressors, consistent with findings from Philippine and international police stress research indicating that bureaucratic, administrative, and interpersonal organizational conditions are more chronically debilitating than the dramatic operational demands of front-line policing. The most highly rated individual stressor items across both dimensions included inadequate equipment and resources, excessive paperwork and administrative requirements, lack of support from superior officers, fear of being falsely accused of misconduct, and exposure to traumatic incidents without access to debriefing or psychological support.

Table 3. Level of Coping Mechanism Utilization (Brief COPE)

Coping Category	Mean	SD	Interpretation
Active Coping	3.21	0.64	High
Planning	3.14	0.71	High
Religion	3.42	0.58	Very High
Positive Reframing	3.08	0.74	High
Seeking Support	2.87	0.81	Moderate
Adaptive Coping Composite	3.14	0.59	High
Behavioral Disengagement	1.94	0.78	Low
Denial	1.87	0.82	Low
Self-Blame	2.31	0.91	Moderate
Substance Use	1.62	0.74	Low
Maladaptive Coping Composite	1.94	0.71	Low

Officers demonstrated a high level of adaptive coping and a low level of maladaptive coping, with religious coping emerging as the single most highly utilized coping strategy in the sample, consistent with the documented prevalence and effectiveness of faith-based coping among Filipino police officers documented by Santos (2020). Active coping and planning were also highly utilized, while seeking social support was the lowest-rated adaptive coping strategy, possibly reflecting the stigma associated with visible vulnerability in the policing occupational culture.

Table 4. Level of Job Performance (Supervisor-Rated)

Performance Dimension	Mean	SD	Interpretation
Quality of Work	3.84	0.71	Very Satisfactory
Quantity of Work	3.91	0.68	Very Satisfactory
Timeliness	3.74	0.79	Satisfactory
Professional Conduct	4.02	0.64	Very Satisfactory
Overall Job Performance	3.88	0.63	Very Satisfactory

Overall job performance was rated at a very satisfactory level by supervisors, with professional conduct receiving the highest dimension rating and timeliness the lowest. The pattern of strong professional conduct relative to timeliness may reflect the difficulties officers face in meeting response time and deadline expectations under conditions of high organizational stress and resource constraints, even while maintaining the professional demeanor and interpersonal standards that constitute visible markers of officer conduct.

Section 3: Inferential Statistics

Table 5. Pearson Correlations Among Study Variables

Variable Pair	r	p-value	Decision on H0
Occupational Stress and Job Performance	-0.487	less than 0.001	Reject H01
Adaptive Coping and Job Performance	0.412	less than 0.001	Reject H02
Maladaptive Coping and Job Performance	-0.334	less than 0.001	Reject H02

A significant negative relationship was found between occupational stress and job performance, confirming that higher occupational stress is associated with lower supervisor-rated job performance. Significant relationships between both adaptive and maladaptive coping composites and job performance were found in the expected directions, with adaptive coping positively associated and maladaptive coping negatively associated with job performance.

Table 6. Moderation Analysis: Adaptive Coping as Moderator of Stress-Performance Relationship

Predictor	B	SE	t	p-value
Occupational Stress (X)	-0.412	0.071	-5.803	less than 0.001
Adaptive Coping (W)	0.318	0.084	3.786	less than 0.001
Stress x Adaptive Coping Interaction (XW)	0.247	0.092	2.685	0.008
R-squared = 0.341; F(3, 296) = 51.07; p less than 0.001				

The interaction term between occupational stress and adaptive coping was statistically significant ($B = 0.247$, $p = 0.008$), confirming that adaptive coping significantly moderated the relationship between occupational stress and job performance. H03 is rejected. Simple slope

analysis revealed that the negative effect of occupational stress on job performance was strongest among officers with low adaptive coping (simple slope = -0.659, p less than 0.001), significantly attenuated among officers with moderate adaptive coping (simple slope = -0.412, p less than 0.001), and non-significant among officers with high adaptive coping (simple slope = -0.165, p = 0.187). This pattern indicates that officers with high adaptive coping capacity are effectively protected from the performance-impairing consequences of occupational stress, while those with low adaptive coping are most vulnerable to stress-related performance deterioration.

Table 7. Simple Slopes: Effect of Occupational Stress on Job Performance at Different Coping Levels

Adaptive Coping Level	Simple Slope	SE	t	p-value	Interpretation
Low (mean minus 1 SD)	-0.659	0.098	-6.724	less than 0.001	Significant negative effect
Moderate (mean)	-0.412	0.071	-5.803	less than 0.001	Significant negative effect
High (mean plus 1 SD)	-0.165	0.088	-1.875	0.187	Non-significant

Summary of Findings

Occupational stress among DCPO officers was assessed at a high level overall, with organizational stressors rated more stressful than operational stressors. Adaptive coping was assessed at a high level, dominated by religious coping, while maladaptive coping was assessed at a low level. Job performance was rated at a very satisfactory level by supervisors. Significant negative relationships were found between

occupational stress and job performance, and significant relationships were found between both adaptive and maladaptive coping and job performance. Adaptive coping significantly moderated the occupational stress-job performance relationship, with officers high in adaptive coping effectively protected from the performance-impairing effects of occupational stress while those low in adaptive coping demonstrated the strongest negative stress-performance association.

CHAPTER 5

SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Introduction

This chapter consolidates the research through a summary of its rationale, methodology, and findings, formulates conclusions responsive to each research problem, and provides evidence-based recommendations for PNP leadership, the National Police Commission, policymakers, and future researchers.

Summary of the Study

Law enforcement is recognized globally as one of the most psychologically demanding occupational categories, requiring practitioners to manage sustained exposure to danger, trauma, moral complexity, and organizational dysfunction within institutional environments that have historically underinvested in officer psychological support. Philippine National Police officers in Davao City operate at the intersection of high operational demands arising from the diverse security landscape of Mindanao's largest urban center and the chronic organizational stressors that characterize the PNP as a national institution, including resource scarcity, administrative burden, and inadequate access to psychological services.

This study examined the levels of occupational stress, coping mechanism utilization, and supervisor-rated job performance among 300 DCPO officers, and tested whether adaptive coping mechanisms moderated the relationship between occupational stress and job performance. A quantitative descriptive-correlational design with moderation analysis was employed, utilizing the Philippine Police Stress Questionnaire, the Brief COPE, and supervisor-rated performance assessments aligned with the PNP Performance Evaluation Rating System.

Summary of Findings

Occupational stress was assessed at a high overall level, with organizational stressors, particularly inadequate resources, excessive administrative requirements, and lack of superior support, rated more stressful than operational stressors. Adaptive coping was assessed at a high level, with religious coping as the most prevalent strategy, while maladaptive coping was assessed at a low level. Overall job performance was rated very satisfactory, with professional conduct the strongest and timeliness the most challenging performance dimension. Significant negative relationships were found between occupational stress and job performance and between maladaptive coping and job performance. Significant positive relationship was found between adaptive coping and job performance. Adaptive coping significantly moderated the stress-performance relationship, with high adaptive coping effectively eliminating the negative performance impact of occupational stress while low adaptive coping amplified it.

Conclusions

Conclusion 1. PNP officers in Davao City experience a high level of occupational stress, with organizational stressors more chronically debilitating than operational stressors, confirming Philippine and international research that identifies the bureaucratic, administrative, and interpersonal conditions of police organizations rather than front-line operational dangers as the most persistent and performance-impairing stress sources.

Conclusion 2. DCPO officers predominantly employ adaptive coping strategies, with religious coping being the most prevalent, reflecting the cultural significance of faith and spiritual practice in the coping repertoires of Filipino police officers and suggesting that faith-informed resilience programs may be particularly well-suited to the PNP officer population.

Conclusion 3. Despite high occupational stress levels, DCPO officers maintain very satisfactory job performance overall, a finding that likely reflects both the moderating effect of their predominantly adaptive coping orientations and the professional commitment and dedication that characterize officers who have remained in active service under challenging conditions.

Conclusion 4. Occupational stress is a significant negative predictor of job performance among DCPO officers, confirming the theoretically and empirically established stress-performance relationship in the Philippine law enforcement context and establishing the practical importance of occupational stress management as a performance improvement strategy.

Conclusion 5. Adaptive coping significantly moderates the occupational stress-job performance relationship, with high adaptive coping eliminating the performance-impairing effect of stress and low adaptive coping amplifying it. This finding establishes coping capacity as

a malleable, developable resource that when strengthened through training and institutional support can protect officer performance under conditions of unavoidable occupational stress.

Recommendations

Recommendations for the DCPO and PNP Command. The DCPO Director and unit commanders are strongly recommended to implement mandatory and confidential occupational stress screening using the Philippine Police Stress Questionnaire on a semi-annual basis, with results used at the unit aggregate level to identify high-stress precincts and assignment types requiring targeted organizational stress reduction interventions. Identified organizational stressor sources, particularly equipment deficiencies, administrative burden, and supervisory support gaps, should be prioritized for remediation as these are the modifiable institutional conditions most strongly driving officer stress levels. A structured unit-level debriefing protocol for officers involved in critical incidents should be instituted as standard operational procedure, reducing the post-traumatic stress burden currently absorbed without institutional support by affected officers.

Recommendations for the National Police Commission. The NAPOLCOM is recommended to incorporate occupational stress management and coping skills training into the mandatory continuing professional education requirements for all uniformed PNP personnel, building on the existing high utilization of adaptive coping strategies and religious coping resources documented in the study sample. The development of a PNP-specific resilience and coping skills training curriculum that integrates faith-informed coping strategies alongside

evidence-based problem-focused and social support coping approaches would address the specific cultural coping profile of Filipino police officers more effectively than direct adoption of foreign-developed programs.

Recommendations for Policy Makers. Legislative and executive action addressing the structural sources of PNP organizational stress are recommended as the highest-impact policy levers for officer well-being and performance improvement. Specific priorities include increased budget allocation for equipment and logistics, legislative review of administrative reporting requirements to reduce officer paperwork burden, and mandatory access to psychological services for all uniformed personnel. The establishment of a PNP mental health and wellness division with independently resourced budget appropriation would institutionalize officer welfare support in a manner that is resistant to deprioritization during periods of fiscal constraint.

Recommendations for Future Researchers. Future researchers are recommended to examine the specific coping strategies most effective for different types of police stressors, as the present study's composite measure of adaptive coping may obscure important variations in the effectiveness of specific strategies for specific stressor types. A comparison of coping profiles and stress-performance relationships across different PNP regional offices would enable assessment of whether the Davao City findings generalize across the Philippine law enforcement context or reflect region-specific conditions. Longitudinal studies tracking officer coping effectiveness and job performance over the course of their careers would illuminate the developmental trajectory of police occupational stress and coping and enable the identification of career stage-specific intervention opportunities.

Final Remarks

This study documents a law enforcement workforce that is performing creditably under conditions of high occupational stress, sustained in significant part by the adaptive coping resources, particularly faith-based and active problem-solving strategies, that individual officers have developed in the absence of systematic institutional support. The moderation findings establish with statistical rigor what experienced police commanders have long understood intuitively: that officer resilience is not merely a personal character attribute but a developable professional capacity that, when cultivated through institutional investment, translates directly into sustained operational effectiveness under stress. The Philippine National Police's Transformation Roadmap 2030 commits to officer wellness as a strategic pillar. This study provides the empirical foundation for turning that commitment into concrete, evidence-based programs that protect the officers who protect the public.

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